GUSTAVO HURTADO SARASTI

Chief Technology Innovation Officer

CONTACT

ghurtadosarasti@gmail.com
+57 310 398 2535
Medellín, Colombia
linkedin.com

CORE COMPETENCIES

- AI Strategy & Agentic AI
- AI Governance & Risk
- Operating Model Design
- Platform Engineering
- Cloud Architecture (AWS)
- Enterprise Modernization
- Revenue & Sales Ownership
- Content Supply Chain
- Nearshore/Offshore Delivery
- CRM Consulting (Agnostic)
- WPP Open Adoption
- C-Level Advisory

RECOGNITION

Cannes Lions Bronze 2024
AdScan for Makro
AI-powered commerce solution

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Technology executive with 20+ years building high-performance engineering organizations at the intersection of creativity, AI, and enterprise transformation. As CTO at VML Colombia (WPP), I lead a 40+ person cross-functional team delivering AI-powered solutions, cloud-native platforms, and immersive experiences for Fortune 500 clients. I combine deep technical expertise in Agentic AI, RAG, and cloud architectures (AWS) with a business-builder mindset — owning a direct revenue target that I consistently meet and exceed ($1.5M–2.1M USD annually). My leadership philosophy centers on connecting creative ambition with engineering rigor, scaling capacity through operational intelligence rather than headcount, and treating technology as a growth lever. Cannes Lions Bronze winner (AdScan, 2024). Currently leading WPP Open adoption and Content Supply Chain development in Colombia.

STRATEGIC ACHIEVEMENTS

- Own and consistently exceed a direct CTO revenue target: $1.5M USD (2024, met), $1.9M USD (2025, exceeded), $2.1M USD (2026, 45% already secured). Lead complex RFP processes and commercial proposals end-to-end, partnering with my engineering team to win enterprise accounts.
- Won Cannes Lions Bronze (2024) with AdScan for Makro — an AI-powered commerce solution leveraging Google Cloud Vision and OpenAI that captured $15.7M in brand media budget and attracted 20,000 new customers annually.
- Selected by Ecopetrol as technology partner to design enterprise AI architecture (Agentic AI, automation, strategic SDLC), earning trust typically reserved for traditional software houses and positioning VML Colombia's COE as a credible enterprise technology provider.
- Scaled team operational capacity through agile reorganization and Agentic AI-assisted workflows — increasing delivery coverage and velocity across projects without growing headcount, protecting both talent wellbeing and operating margin.
- Built VML Colombia's Innovation Lab into a Creative Tech hub now serving offices across North America (Kansas City, New York), Mexico, Costa Rica, and Puerto Rico.
- Leading WPP Open evangelization and adoption from Colombia, driving platform integration and AI-native workflows across the regional operation.
- Building a Content Supply Chain model for enterprise clients (2026), designing end-to-end content production workflows powered by AI and creative technology.
- Delivered XR experiences (AR, VR, MR) for Bancolombia, Carulla, and Colombiamoda — translating creative ambition into production-grade immersive solutions with my engineering team.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Chief Technology Innovation Officer

VML Colombia (WPP) | May 2021 – Present

Lead 40+ person cross-functional technology organization (Engineering, Experience Design, Creative Tech) delivering enterprise solutions and AI-powered platforms for clients across LATAM and North America. Own technology strategy, innovation roadmap, nearshore delivery model, and direct revenue targets. Lead WPP Open evangelization and Content Supply Chain development for the region.

- Won Cannes Lions Bronze (2024) with AdScan for Makro, combining Google Cloud Vision + OpenAI to create an AI commerce platform that captured $15.7M in media budget.
- Designed enterprise AI architecture for Ecopetrol (Agentic AI, automation, SDLC strategy), earning the trust of one of LATAM's largest enterprises as a technology COE partner.
- Architected technology strategy for Coca-Cola's OneXP/XTND platforms and 3rd-party experience ecosystem, winning competitive RFPs against consulting firms.
- Designed AI-agent recognition platform architecture for Abbott, applying Agentic AI and RAG techniques with the engineering team.
- Scaled operational capacity via agile restructuring and Agentic AI tooling, expanding delivery coverage without increasing team size.
- Built nearshore/offshore model positioning Colombia as tech delivery hub for VML North America.

TECH CAPABILITIES

- Agentic AI & RAG
- GenAI / LLM Orchestration
- Computer Vision & OCR
- AWS Cloud Architecture
- API-First / SOA
- Microservices & Serverless
- Salesforce (Consulting)
- HubSpot CRM
- Ecommerce Platforms
- XR (AR/VR/MR)
- IoT & Creative Tech
- Bots & ML / Robotics

TECH STACK

- AWS
- .NET / WPF
- SOA & REST APIs
- Google Cloud Vision
- 3D Printing
- CMS Platforms
- Mobile & Web Dev
- Databases

EDUCATION

B.Sc. Systems Engineering
Universidad Del Cauca
Colombia • 1999–2004

University Lecturer
OOP, Data Structures,
Computing Theory
Universidad Del Cauca • 2005

LANGUAGES

- Spanish (Native)
- English (B2 – Professional)

SELECT CLIENTS

Coca-Cola • Ecopetrol
Abbott • Makro • AB InBev
Sherwin-Williams
Telefónica • Bancolombia
SURA • Kimberly Clark
Colgate • Bridgestone
Frito-Lay • Grupo Éxito
Coors Light • Protección
Argos

Director of Innovation & Technology

Isobar / Dentsu Creative | Mar 2016 – Dec 2020

Built the innovation function from scratch (NowLab), established technology roadmaps, launched XR/IoT/Creative Tech capabilities, and created the international alliances business unit. Led a team of 20+ engineers and creatives.

- Led pioneering XR projects: VR Virtual Office (Bancolombia), AR Smart Market (Carulla), MR Future of Fashion (Colombiamoda).
- Created the agency's technology and innovation roadmap, adopted across the Dentsu Creative LATAM network.
- Built and launched ecommerce business unit, driving a new revenue stream for the agency.

Lead of Digital Transformation

Equitel Ventures | Dec 2020 – Dec 2024 (Part-time)

Advisory role connecting innovation strategy with product development, leveraging technology as the core enabler for new business models in the telecommunications sector.

EARLIER CAREER

Technical Lead | VML, Bogotá | 2015–2016

Led web development team for Kimberly Clark enterprise account. Managed regional implementation of 6 Huggies websites across LATAM.

Director of Digital Marketing | Aranda Software, Bogotá | 2014–2015

Built the B2B digital marketing function from zero. Designed and executed inbound marketing campaigns across 12 regional offices. Led development of Kleap service desk product.

Founder & Country Manager | 3Metas (Startup), Bogotá | 2009–2012

Founded and led a digital strategy consultancy for 3.5 years, building the operational model, commercial function, and technical architecture practice from the ground up.

Software Engineer | BizAgi • TES America Andina, Bogotá | 2005–2008

Core product development roles building enterprise BPM and IT management solutions. Technologies: .NET, WCF, SOA, ClickOnce.

LEADERSHIP PHILOSOPHY

I believe the most impactful technology leaders don't just build systems — they build organizations that can continuously adapt. My approach centers on three principles: **connect creativity with engineering rigor** to solve problems others can't frame; **scale capacity through intelligence, not headcount** — protecting people and margin simultaneously; and **treat technology as a growth lever**, not a cost center. I lead teams that are equally comfortable in a board presentation and a code review.

OPERATING MODEL & GOVERNANCE

- Designed and deployed nearshore/offshore delivery model with dedicated squads, SLA frameworks, and capacity planning across multiple geographies.
- Reorganized agile operations and introduced Agentic AI tooling to maximize team velocity and delivery coverage while maintaining team size and wellbeing.
- Built cost optimization framework for AI workloads on AWS, reducing cloud spend through workload right-sizing and resource optimization strategies.
- Implemented platform thinking approach, creating reusable technology components and accelerators that reduced project delivery timelines.
- Leading Content Supply Chain model design for enterprise clients, architecting end-to-end content workflows powered by AI.